



05 Bestiary Catalog

How to use creature stat blocks

Creatures in Adventures in Alba are more than numbers, but the numbers help the Guide pace scenes. Every creature has HP, MP, Level, a Difficulty Rating, classic stats, and plenty of story hooks.



Creature rule: every creature has a feeling, a wish, useful stats, and a safe complication.

Creature rolls: when a creature acts against a hero, roll d6 + the creature stat. Use results to create funny trouble, not punishment.

Stat	Creature use
Strength	Push, hold, carry, stomp, protect.
Int	Riddles, tricks, memories, old magic.
Agility	Race, dodge, fly, swim, sneak.
Wis	Feelings, nature, noticing, animal sense.
Luck	Fairy weirdness, charm magic, surprises.

DIFFICULTY RATING

Formula: DR = round((HP + MP + Level×3 + positive stat bonuses×2) ÷ 10). Minimum DR is 1.

DR	Meaning	Use at table
1	Tiny trouble	One adventurer can usually solve it with a good idea.
2	Small scene	Good for a warm-up creature or comic obstacle.
3	Fair challenge	Needs teamwork, a spell, or two rolls.
4	Big scene	Use as the main creature for an adventure.
5+	Boss or wonder	Use rarely; make it emotional, not scary.

Balancing tip: for Adventurers 5–7, “harder” should mean more choices and more wonder, not harsher consequences.



CREATURE STAT BLOCK

MOON-KELPIE FOAL

A nervous water-pony adventurer with a kelp mane and a moon-bell collar. It wants to be brave but splashes when startled.

It circles moonlit shallows where lost songs sink. If heroes speak gently, it lowers its head so the bell-shaped mark on its collar can be seen. It is not trying to block the path; it is afraid the loch will forget bedtime.

HP 9	MP 4	LVL 1	DR 3	
STR +1	INT +0	AGI +2	WIS +1	LUK +1

DR formula: $\text{round}((\text{HP } 9 + \text{MP } 4 + \text{Level } 1 \times 3 + \text{positive stats } 5 \times 2) \div 10) = 3$.

Wants

Its moon-bell returned.

Helps by

Carries one hero safely across shallow water.

Moves

- Moonlit Splash (1 MP): makes stepping stones shimmer for one turn.
- Foal Gallop: races across water if someone sings softly.

Complication

Splashes the map when startled.

Gentle approach

Name its feeling, offer one kind idea, then roll only if the moment is exciting.

Treasure/friend reward

A clue, safe path, charm, drawing prompt, or promise for later.



CREATURE STAT BLOCK

THISTLE SPRITE

A tiny proud fairy with a thorn crown too large for its head. It guards paths because it secretly feels lonely.

It announces itself with trumpet noises made from a grass stem. The crown keeps sliding over one eye, but the sprite insists this is royal fashion. It wants respect, company, and one job that feels important.

HP 6	MP 6	LVL 2	DR 3	
STR -1	INT +1	AGI +2	WIS +0	LUK +2

DR formula: $\text{round}((\text{HP } 6 + \text{MP } 6 + \text{Level } 2 \times 3 + \text{positive stats } 5 \times 2) \div 10) = 3$.

Wants

Someone to admire its thorn crown.

Helps by

Shows a hidden fairy path.

Moves

- Prickle Point (1 MP): blocks a rude shortcut with harmless thistles.
- Royal Decree: demands a compliment or tiny flag.

Complication

Gets offended by rude pointing.

Gentle approach

Name its feeling, offer one kind idea, then roll only if the moment is exciting.

Treasure/friend reward

A clue, safe path, charm, drawing prompt, or promise for later.



CREATURE STAT BLOCK

MOSS TROLL NAPPER

A huge mossy troll who only wants a quiet nap. Birds nest in its hair and bubbles puff from its nose.

This troll is older than several bridges and softer than it looks. Adventurers may climb its mossy shoulder if they ask first. It becomes a problem when its snores roll downhill and shake clues loose from the trees.

HP 18	MP 2	LVL 3	DR 4	
STR +3	INT +0	AGI -1	WIS +1	LUK +0

DR formula: $\text{round}((\text{HP } 18 + \text{MP } 2 + \text{Level } 3 \times 3 + \text{positive stats } 4 \times 2) \div 10) = 4$.

Wants

A quieter place to nap.

Helps by

Lifts a log bridge.

Moves

- Gentle Lift: moves something heavy without breaking it.
- Bubble Snore (1 MP): floats clues away unless caught.

Complication

Snores bubbles that float away clues.

Gentle approach

Name its feeling, offer one kind idea, then roll only if the moment is exciting.

Treasure/friend reward

A clue, safe path, charm, drawing prompt, or promise for later.



CREATURE STAT BLOCK

SILVER FOX FAMILIAR

A polite fox with silver whiskers, clever eyes, and too many compliments. It knows tracks no one else can see.

The fox belongs to no wizard but knows every wizard worth knowing. It speaks in compliments because a curse once made rude words taste like nettles. It tests heroes with riddles to learn whether they listen.

HP 10	MP 5	LVL 3	DR 4	
STR +0	INT +2	AGI +2	WIS +1	LUK +1

DR formula: $\text{round}((\text{HP } 10 + \text{MP } 5 + \text{Level } 3 \times 3 + \text{positive stats } 6 \times 2) \div 10) = 4$.

Wants

A riddle answered.

Helps by

Leads heroes to tracks.

Moves

- Compliment Riddle (1 MP): gives a clue wrapped in praise.
- Silver Step: vanishes behind moonlit grass.

Complication

Only speaks in compliments.

Gentle approach

Name its feeling, offer one kind idea, then roll only if the moment is exciting.

Treasure/friend reward

A clue, safe path, charm, drawing prompt, or promise for later.



CREATURE STAT BLOCK

ROWAN OWL

An old owl wearing rowan berries like spectacles. It sees through mist but forgets names at the funniest time.

It remembers storms from before the village had a name, but it may call a lantern a “little sun bucket.” Heroes who are patient receive excellent advice hidden inside silly mistakes.

HP 11	MP 6	LVL 4	DR 4	
STR +0	INT +2	AGI +1	WIS +3	LUK +0

DR formula: $\text{round}((\text{HP } 11 + \text{MP } 6 + \text{Level } 4 \times 3 + \text{positive stats } 6 \times 2) \div 10) = 4$.

Wants

Help remembering a name.

Helps by

Sees through mist.

Moves

- Mist Sight (1 MP): spots hidden doors or feelings.
- Old Acorn Advice: gives wise advice with one wrong noun.

Complication

Calls everyone “young acorn.”

Gentle approach

Name its feeling, offer one kind idea, then roll only if the moment is exciting.

Treasure/friend reward

A clue, safe path, charm, drawing prompt, or promise for later.



CREATURE STAT BLOCK

HEATHER HARE

A fast hare with a red ribbon tangled around one paw. It is worried, quick, and very easy to startle.

The hare carries messages between hill paths but cannot sit still long enough to explain them. It thumps warnings in complicated rhythms. A calm hero can turn the thumps into a map.

HP 8	MP 3	LVL 2	DR 3	
STR +0	INT +0	AGI +3	WIS +1	LUK +1

DR formula: $\text{round}((\text{HP } 8 + \text{MP } 3 + \text{Level } 2 \times 3 + \text{positive stats } 5 \times 2) \div 10) = 3$.

Wants

Its red ribbon untangled.

Helps by

Carries a message.

Moves

- Zigzag Dash: outruns almost anything on open heather.
- Ear Twitch (1 MP): hears danger before it arrives.

Complication

Keeps changing direction.

Gentle approach

Name its feeling, offer one kind idea, then roll only if the moment is exciting.

Treasure/friend reward

A clue, safe path, charm, drawing prompt, or promise for later.



CREATURE STAT BLOCK

TEACUP DRAGON

A biscuit-sized dragon who lives in warm cups and thinks it is enormous. Its sparks are bright but small.

It roars into teaspoons, sleeps on folded napkins, and hoards sugar crystals. It is proud, but a sincere apology and a biscuit can turn it into a tiny furnace for helpful steam.

HP 9	MP 6	LVL 3	DR 3	
STR +1	INT +1	AGI +1	WIS +0	LUK +2

DR formula: $\text{round}((\text{HP } 9 + \text{MP } 6 + \text{Level } 3 \times 3 + \text{positive stats } 5 \times 2) \div 10) = 3$.

Wants

A biscuit and apology.

Helps by

Boils water for tea or steam clues.

Moves

- Steam Puff (1 MP): reveals invisible writing.
- Spark Sneeze (1 MP): lights a candle or startles a puddle.

Complication

Sneezes sparks into puddles.

Gentle approach

Name its feeling, offer one kind idea, then roll only if the moment is exciting.

Treasure/friend reward

A clue, safe path, charm, drawing prompt, or promise for later.



CREATURE STAT BLOCK

LOCH LANTERN JELLY

A shy glowing jelly that floats under dark water like a little lantern. It dims when shouted at.

It drifts below the surface where moonlight cannot reach. Brave noises frighten it; soft questions brighten it. If befriended, it can show safe stones under black water.

HP 7	MP 7	LVL 3	DR 3	
STR -1	INT +0	AGI +1	WIS +2	LUK +2

DR formula: $\text{round}((\text{HP } 7 + \text{MP } 7 + \text{Level } 3 \times 3 + \text{positive stats } 5 \times 2) \div 10) = 3$.

Wants

A dark pool made less lonely.

Helps by

Lights underwater steps.

Moves

- Soft Glow (1 MP): lights a safe route beneath the surface.
- Drift Away: escapes loud scenes without anger.

Complication

Floats away if shouted at.

Gentle approach

Name its feeling, offer one kind idea, then roll only if the moment is exciting.

Treasure/friend reward

A clue, safe path, charm, drawing prompt, or promise for later.



CREATURE STAT BLOCK

BOG-BOOT BROWNIE

A muddy household fairy who loves cleaning boots, even when boots are not the problem.

It lives where the road becomes mud and treats every bootprint as a personal letter. The brownie can read a trail from one splash mark, but it may scrub away the clue unless heroes ask quickly and kindly.

HP 8	MP 3	LVL 2	DR 3	
STR +1	INT +2	AGI +1	WIS +1	LUK +0

DR formula: $\text{round}((\text{HP } 8 + \text{MP } 3 + \text{Level } 2 \times 3 + \text{positive stats } 5 \times 2) \div 10) = 3$.

Wants

A pair of boots to clean.

Helps by

Finds footprints.

Moves

- Mud Map: reads footprints like a story.
- Scrub Scrub (1 MP): cleans one item until it shines.

Complication

Cleans the wrong thing first.

Gentle approach

Name its feeling, offer one kind idea, then roll only if the moment is exciting.

Treasure/friend reward

A clue, safe path, charm, drawing prompt, or promise for later.



CREATURE STAT BLOCK

CLOUD SHEEP

A dreamy sheep made of soft cloud wool. It drifts through sky meadows and forgets which star is its shepherd.

Cloud Sheep nibble moon-mist and bump gently into hills. Their wool holds dreams: touch it and you may remember a lullaby. They follow laughter, which is charming until they drift away from home.

HP 10	MP 8	LVL 4	DR 4	
STR +1	INT +0	AGI +1	WIS +1	LUK +3

DR formula: $\text{round}((\text{HP } 10 + \text{MP } 8 + \text{Level } 4 \times 3 + \text{positive stats } 6 \times 2) \div 10) = 4$.

Wants

A shepherd star.

Helps by

Makes a fluffy bridge.

Moves

- Cloud Bridge (2 MP): makes one soft crossing for careful feet.
- Dream Drift (1 MP): carries a clue into the sky.

Complication

Drifts when adventurers giggle.

Gentle approach

Name its feeling, offer one kind idea, then roll only if the moment is exciting.

Treasure/friend reward

A clue, safe path, charm, drawing prompt, or promise for later.



CREATURE STAT BLOCK

GLOAMING BOG HAG

A reed-crowned bog witch who looks scary in twilight but mostly wants people to stop dropping rubbish in her marsh.

Her lantern eyes blink through fog and her cloak smells of peat. She mutters old rhymes that make puddles answer. Brave adventurers may discover she is guarding tadpoles and a sunken road sign.

HP 16	MP 10	LVL 5	DR 6	
STR +1	INT +2	AGI +0	WIS +3	LUK +1

DR formula: $\text{round}((\text{HP } 16 + \text{MP } 10 + \text{Level } 5 \times 3 + \text{positive stats } 7 \times 2) \div 10) = 6$.

Wants

The marsh cleaned and her tadpoles protected.

Helps by

Reveals safe stepping stones through the bog.

Moves

- Bog Fog Spell (2 MP): fills the scene with mist; Agility or Wis avoids getting turned around.
- Reed Hex (1 MP): sticky reeds grab boots for 2 HP of trouble.
- Lantern Stare: asks one honest question no one should dodge.

Complication

Sounds frightening even when saying helpful things.

Gentle approach

Name its feeling, offer one kind idea, then roll only if the moment is exciting.

Treasure/friend reward

A clue, safe path, charm, drawing prompt, or promise for later.



CREATURE STAT BLOCK

CAIRN WIGHT

A blue-lit guardian made of old cairn stones and memory. It is spooky, slow, and very serious about promises.

The Cairn Wight rises when someone forgets a vow made on the hill. Stones grind like thunder, but it never chases farther than its cairn circle. It wants the correct name spoken kindly.

HP 22	MP 6	LVL 5	DR 6	
STR +3	INT +1	AGI -1	WIS +2	LUK +0

DR formula: $\text{round}((\text{HP } 22 + \text{MP } 6 + \text{Level } 5 \times 3 + \text{positive stats } 6 \times 2) \div 10) = 6$.

Wants

A forgotten promise remembered.

Helps by

Opens the hill path to an old treasure.

Moves

- Stone Sleep (2 MP): heavy drowsiness makes heroes sit unless they sing or move.
- Cairn Slam: shakes the ground for 3 HP of startling trouble.
- Memory Riddle (1 MP): asks a name from the past.

Complication

Blocks the path until someone speaks respectfully.

Gentle approach

Name its feeling, offer one kind idea, then roll only if the moment is exciting.

Treasure/friend reward

A clue, safe path, charm, drawing prompt, or promise for later.



CREATURE STAT BLOCK

REDCAP BRAMBLE SNEAK

A thorny little goblin with a red berry cap, sharp giggles, and a habit of stealing shiny bells.

It hides in brambles and pretends to be fierce. The red cap is not blood; it is mashed berries and jam. It steals because it thinks shiny things keep the dark away.

HP 12	MP 5	LVL 3	DR 4	
STR +0	INT +1	AGI +3	WIS +0	LUK +2

DR formula: $\text{round}((\text{HP } 12 + \text{MP } 5 + \text{Level } 3 \times 3 + \text{positive stats } 6 \times 2) \div 10) = 4$.

Wants

A shiny bell, button, or brave night-light.

Helps by

Shows a secret thorn tunnel.

Moves

- Thorn Tangle (1 MP): vines snag cloaks for 2 HP of trouble.
- Jam-Cap Vanish: hides in berry brambles after a wobble.
- Shriek Sneak: startles one hero unless a friend helps.

Complication

Acts mean until someone notices it is afraid of the dark.

Gentle approach

Name its feeling, offer one kind idea, then roll only if the moment is exciting.

Treasure/friend reward

A clue, safe path, charm, drawing prompt, or promise for later.



CREATURE STAT BLOCK

NIGHT THISTLE DRAGON

A small shadow dragon curled around glowing purple thistles. It puffs lavender smoke and guards dreams too fiercely.

This dragon is not huge, but the dark makes it look larger. It hoards nightmares in thistle pods so villages can sleep, then forgets to let the good dreams out again.

HP 20	MP 12	LVL 6	DR 7	
STR +2	INT +1	AGI +2	WIS +1	LUK +3

DR formula: $\text{round}((\text{HP } 20 + \text{MP } 12 + \text{Level } 6 \times 3 + \text{positive stats } 9 \times 2) \div 10) = 7$.

Wants

Help sorting good dreams from bad ones.

Helps by

Burns away nightmare fog with purple starlight.

Moves

- Lavender Smoke Spell (2 MP): sleepy smoke; Wis or Luck stays focused.
- Thistle Breath (2 MP): prickly shadow blast for 3 HP of trouble.
- Dream Hoard: reveals a clue hidden inside a dream pod.

Complication

Protects the wrong dream and will not listen until praised.

Gentle approach

Name its feeling, offer one kind idea, then roll only if the moment is exciting.

Treasure/friend reward

A clue, safe path, charm, drawing prompt, or promise for later.



CREATURE STAT BLOCK

HOLLOW HILL BANSHEE

A pale wind-spirit whose cry sounds scary because she is trying to warn the hill, not hurt anyone.

Her ribbons flutter through fairy mounds and old doorways. She appears before storms, broken promises, and lost songs. Adventurers who listen hear words inside the wail: names, paths, and warnings.

HP 14	MP 14	LVL 6	DR 6	
STR -1	INT +1	AGI +2	WIS +3	LUK +2

DR formula: $\text{round}((\text{HP } 14 + \text{MP } 14 + \text{Level } 6 \times 3 + \text{positive stats } 8 \times 2) \div 10) = 6$.

Wants

A sad song finished and a warning believed.

Helps by

Warns of danger before it arrives.

Moves

- Warning Wail (2 MP): everyone must roll Wis or lose a turn covering ears.
- Wind Ribbon (1 MP): moves one item across the scene.
- Ghost Door: opens a fairy mound for one careful promise.

Complication

Her helpful warning sounds like a frightening scream.

Gentle approach

Name its feeling, offer one kind idea, then roll only if the moment is exciting.

Treasure/friend reward

A clue, safe path, charm, drawing prompt, or promise for later.

CREATURE BUILDER

Roll	Animal	Fairy twist	Best stat
1	Fox	silver whiskers	Int
2	Hare	bell tail	Agility
3	Owl	moon glasses	Wis
4	Pony	kelp mane	Strength
5	Dragon	teacup size	Luck
6	Sheep	cloud wool	Luck

Example: A kelp-mane pony has HP 9, MP 4, Level 1, Strength +1, Agility +2, Wis +1, Luck +1. DR = $\text{round}((9+4+3+10)/10) = 3$.

Set HP and MP

Tiny: HP 6–8, MP 2–4. Normal: HP 9–12, MP 3–6. Big: HP 15+, MP 2–8.

Set the stats

Pick one +3, one +2, two +1, and one +0. Very tiny creatures may have one -1 and one +3.

Calculate DR

$\text{DR} = \text{round}((\text{HP} + \text{MP} + \text{Level} \times 3 + \text{positive stats} \times 2) \div 10)$. Minimum 1.

Make it adventurer-friendly

Replace defeat with help, chase, song, puzzle, promise, snack, or finding a lost thing.

CREATURE TACTICS WITHOUT SCARY COMBAT

What enemies do

- **Guard:** blocks a path until a promise is made.
- **Grab:** takes a hat, map, boot, spoon, or bell.
- **Hide:** runs into mist, reeds, cupboards, or clouds.
- **Challenge:** asks for a race, riddle, song, or brave sentence.
- **Spend MP:** uses one magical move, then gets tired or silly.

At 0 HP: enemies stop, slump, nap, cry, apologise, or ask for help. No gore, no cruelty.

Difficulty in scenes

Party	Good DR	Use
1 new hero	1–2	One creature, one clear want.
2–3 heroes	2–3	Teamwork or one spell helps.
4 heroes	3–4	Main scene, multiple approaches.
Finale	4–5	Big wonder, many friends return.

Guide note: if a DR feels too high, reduce HP by 2 or MP by 1, or make the creature want help sooner.





CREATURE STAT BLOCK

BLACK BOG DRAKE

A low, tar-black drake with peat smoke nostrils and ember eyes. It coils under rotten bridges and hates bright lanterns.

Bog drakes are born where old battle magic sinks into marsh water. They are dangerous guardians, but they can be tricked by clean fire, honest songs, or offering to drain poisoned pools.

HP 28	MP 10	LVL 7	DR 8	
STR +4	INT +1	AGI +1	WIS +1	LUK +2

DR formula: $\text{round}((\text{HP } 28 + \text{MP } 10 + \text{Level } 7 \times 3 + \text{positive stats } 9 \times 2) \div 10) = 8$.

Wants

The bog left undisturbed and its poisoned pool cleansed.

Helps by

Guards a hidden causeway after being respected.

Moves / spells

- Peat-Smoke Breath (2 MP): Startled and lost unless Wis resists.
- Bog Snap: 3 HP trouble and Tangled boots.
- Sinkhole Coil (2 MP): changes the map by opening black mud.

Complication

Hates lantern-light but follows songs.

Approach

Break the oath, collar, curse, banner, or false command that makes this enemy dangerous.

Reward

A route, truce, freed ally, map, hoard clue, or faction reputation.



CREATURE STAT BLOCK

BORDER WARG OF THE RED WALL

An armored grey wolf bred by southern war-mages. It wears broken Albion chain and smells fear through stone.

These wargs are not evil by nature; they were trained by conquerors. A freed warg may become a fierce protector of Alba.

HP 24	MP 6	LVL 6	DR 7	
STR +3	INT +1	AGI +3	WIS +2	LUK +0

DR formula: $\text{round}((\text{HP } 24 + \text{MP } 6 + \text{Level } 6 \times 3 + \text{positive stats } 9 \times 2) \div 10) = 7$.

Wants

Freedom from a cruel command collar.

Helps by

Tracks raiders and warns of border patrols.

Moves / spells

- Command Howl (1 MP): Startled unless a friend steadies you.
- Iron Pounce: 3 HP trouble or knocked prone.
- Scent the Fear: finds a hidden nervous target.

Complication

Obeys the collar until it is broken.

Approach

Break the oath, collar, curse, banner, or false command that makes this enemy dangerous.

Reward

A route, truce, freed ally, map, hoard clue, or faction reputation.



CREATURE STAT BLOCK

DRAUGR OATH-RAIDER

A sea-dead Norse warrior in barnacled mail who rises when a ship oath is broken. Its eyes burn cold blue.

Draugr remember treasure, feasts, and betrayal. They can be laid to rest by returning a stolen token or finishing the oath carved on their shield.

HP 26	MP 8	LVL 7	DR 7	
STR +3	INT +1	AGI +0	WIS +2	LUK +1

DR formula: $\text{round}((\text{HP } 26 + \text{MP } 8 + \text{Level } 7 \times 3 + \text{positive stats } 7 \times 2) \div 10) = 7$.

Wants

Its broken ship-oath completed.

Helps by

Reveals a sea route or buried hoard.

Moves / spells

- Cold Oath Grip (2 MP): Sleepy and slowed until warmed.
- Shield-Rattle: fear noise; Wis to stand firm.
- Grave Tide (2 MP): water rises across the map.

Complication

Cannot cross a properly spoken guest-right promise.

Approach

Break the oath, collar, curse, banner, or false command that makes this enemy dangerous.

Reward

A route, truce, freed ally, map, hoard clue, or faction reputation.



CREATURE STAT BLOCK

IRON CROW SWARM

A murder of black iron-feathered crows that steals secrets, buttons, and battlefield names.

Iron Crows gather where tyrants write false histories. They are terrifying in numbers but love bargains involving true names and shiny lies.

HP 18	MP 12	LVL 6	DR 7	
STR +0	INT +3	AGI +4	WIS +1	LUK +2

DR formula: $\text{round}((\text{HP } 18 + \text{MP } 12 + \text{Level } 6 \times 3 + \text{positive stats } 10 \times 2) \div 10) = 7$.

Wants

A secret worth carrying.

Helps by

Delivers a message across enemy lines.

Moves / spells

- Secret Peck (1 MP): steals one clue until asked the right question.
- Wing-Dark (2 MP): makes the scene dim and noisy.
- False Echo: repeats words in the wrong voice.

Complication

Cannot resist a polished lie or true apology.

Approach

Break the oath, collar, curse, banner, or false command that makes this enemy dangerous.

Reward

A route, truce, freed ally, map, hoard clue, or faction reputation.



CREATURE STAT BLOCK

ALBION REDCLOAK CAPTAIN

A stern commander from the southern Dominion of Albion, wearing a red cloak and carrying a banner that tries to make Alba kneel.

The Redcloak Captain represents a fantasy imperial faction, not a real people. Some Albion folk are ordinary traders and neighbors; the Dominion army is the villain.

HP 22	MP 6	LVL 6	DR 6	
STR +2	INT +2	AGI +1	WIS +0	LUK +1

DR formula: $\text{round}((\text{HP } 22 + \text{MP } 6 + \text{Level } 6 \times 3 + \text{positive stats } 6 \times 2) \div 10) = 6$.

Wants

Taxes, maps, and obedience for the Dominion.

Helps by

May retreat or bargain if shown the land itself rejects conquest.

Moves / spells

- Banner Command (2 MP): nearby minions gain +1 until the banner falls.
- Shield Wall: blocks a path unless outflanked or persuaded.
- Orderly Threat: Startled unless someone answers boldly.

Complication

Underestimates fairy law and local clans.

Approach

Break the oath, collar, curse, banner, or false command that makes this enemy dangerous.

Reward

A route, truce, freed ally, map, hoard clue, or faction reputation.

MONSTER TACTICS: SCARY BUT PLAYABLE

Use real danger

- Let monsters hurt plans, gear, courage, position, and resources.
- Use 2–3 HP trouble for ordinary hits; 3 HP for boss specials.
- Make fear visible: thunder, banners, howls, cold breath, sinking ground.
- Always show a counter: oath, light, true name, broken collar, lost token.

Faction monsters

Enemy	What stops it
Redcloak patrol	local law, fairy oath, clever terrain.
Norse draugr	completed oath or returned ship-token.
Barbarian raider	honour challenge, feast-right, or clan bargain.
Bog horror	clean water, lantern, song, or drained curse.